

TSANGAI BUSINESS GROWTH SERIES · #02

Buy Back 10 Hours Every Week

Find the 10 hours hiding in your calendar, hand the busywork to AI, and get your evenings back — without hiring anyone.

WHO IT'S FOR

Owners working 50+ hour weeks who can't remember their last free evening

TIME REQUIRED

15 minutes

WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

A ranked list of your 10 most wasteful hours — and your first one automated

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Your calendar is full of \$15/hour work. You're not a \$15/hour person.

This playbook helps you find the low-value tasks eating your week, then shows you how to hand the biggest one to AI today.

Every owner I meet says the same thing: "I just need more hours." You don't. You need fewer tasks. The hours are already there — they're just buried under email, scheduling, and admin that AI can do faster than you. Let's dig them out.

— Ray, TsangAI Consulting

WHY THIS MATTERS

10+ hrs

Typical weekly hours owners spend on email, scheduling, and admin

500 hrs

That's 500+ hours a year — three full months of workdays

÷ 4

Your "buyback rate": what your time is worth, divided by four

THE ONE IDEA

Don't manage your time. Audit it — then buy it back.

Every task on your plate has a price. If a task is worth less than your buyback rate, you should never do it again. AI is the cheapest "hire" that has ever existed for this kind of work.

Example: A cleaning company owner spent 6 hours a week replying to booking emails. An AI assistant now drafts every reply; she reviews and hits send in 40 minutes. That's 5+ hours back — every single week.

YOUR 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN

- ☐ Open your sent email and calendar from last week
- ☐ List every task you touched more than 3 times (page 4 worksheet)
- ☐ Mark each one: Delete, AI, Delegate, or Keep
- ☐ Count the hours next to "Delete" and "AI" — that's your buyback target

Five steps to your first 10 hours

1 Run the time audit

List everything you did last week that took 30+ minutes. Your sent folder and calendar don't lie.

Do this: Fill in the worksheet on page 4. Aim for 10–15 tasks.

2 Calculate your buyback rate

Take what an hour of your time is worth and divide by four. Any task below that number is stealing from you.

Do this: Write your rate at the top of the worksheet. Example: $\$200/\text{hr} \div 4 = \50 .

3 Tag every task: Delete, AI, Delegate, or Keep

Delete what nobody would miss. Tag "AI" on anything repetitive with words or data. Delegate what needs a human. Keep only what truly needs *you*.

Do this: One tag per row. No blanks allowed.

4 Automate your #1 "AI" task today

Pick the AI-tagged task with the most hours. For most owners it's email. Use the prompt on page 4 to set up your reply assistant in 10 minutes.

Do this: Paste the prompt into ChatGPT or Claude and test it on 3 real emails.

5 Protect the hours you just freed

Saved time evaporates unless you claim it. Block the freed hours for the work only you can do — sales, hiring, strategy, or actually going home.

Do this: Add a recurring calendar block named "Bought-back time."

COMMON MISTAKES

This is where most business owners get stuck.

They audit from memory instead of the calendar — and miss half the leaks. They keep tasks because "clients expect me personally." And they free up 5 hours, then fill them with more busywork.

PRO TIP

Don't aim for perfect AI drafts — aim for 80% drafts you edit in 30 seconds. Owners who wait for perfect automation save nothing. Owners who accept "almost right, instantly" save 10 hours a week.

Your worksheet, your rate, your first automation

The Time Audit Worksheet My buyback rate: \$_____ / hour

TASK I DID LAST WEEK	HRS/WEEK	WORTH \$/HR?	DELETE / AI / DELEGATE / KEEP
Replying to routine emails	___	___	___
Scheduling and rescheduling	___	___	___
Writing quotes / proposals	___	___	___
Chasing invoices / follow-ups	___	___	___
Writing social posts / marketing	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___
_____	___	___	___

The Email Buyback Prompt

You are my email assistant at [BUSINESS NAME], a [WHAT YOU DO] business. Our tone is friendly, brief, and professional. When I paste a customer email, draft a reply that: 1) answers their question directly, 2) offers the next step (usually [BOOKING LINK / QUOTE / CALL]), 3) stays under 120 words. If information is missing, ask me one clarifying question instead of guessing. Here's the email: [PASTE EMAIL]

The "Should I Keep This Task?" Test

- ✓ Would a customer notice — or care — if AI did the first draft? If no: **AI**.
- ✓ Does it follow the same pattern every time? If yes: **AI**.
- ✓ Does it need my judgment, relationships, or signature? If yes: **Keep** (but let AI prep it).
- ✓ Would anything break if it stopped entirely? If no: **Delete**.

Turn this guide into one win this week.

A guide you read changes nothing. A page you fill in does. Two minutes — do it while it's fresh.

1 • WHERE I AM TODAY

Hours my audit found: _____ / week My buyback rate: \$ _____ / hr

2 • THE ONE THING I'M FIXING THIS WEEK

My one fix: _____

The first small step (under 15 minutes): _____

Small beats big. Pick something you can finish in one sitting.

3 • WHEN I'M DOING IT

Day: _____ Time: _____ Booked in my calendar? ☐

Open your calendar and book it now — a plan without a time slot is a wish.

4 • AFTER — WHAT HAPPENED

My result (hours saved, jobs booked, thing shipped): _____

What I'll do differently next time: _____

NOTES

KEEP THE STREAK

One fix a week is 52 upgrades a year. When this page is full, re-take the guide — a rising score is proof your systems are working.